



Black interest comes in Trigere's spill-skirt, wool crepe dinner dress, left. On the other side of the Black Diamond elephant skull is Donald Brooks' bright wool crepe in a Greek motif.

Should a Diplodocus Go Maxi to the Ball?

BY BEVERLY MAURICE
Fashion Editor

Can a beautiful girl model be happy competing with a dinosaur in a fashion photo? Now right offhand, you'd think there's no problem, you know, the competition is so much older, but...

There is this dinosaur lying languorously on a sort of chaise longue there at the Museum of Natural History, bones gleaming brightly in pristine white as though it brushed daily with a secret formula of Poree & Crest.

Let the model don white and she blends in with the skeletal scenery. Put her in black, especially since it's so RIGHT these days and she's lost in the vast reaches of the museum halls.

Never let it be said we girls would give up without trying. Naturally we've come up with two solutions, first, dress the

Dinosaur, from the black tie benefit of the same name, and second, dress the girls brightly.

You know that anything done jointly by Neiman-Marcus and the Museum of Natural Science is going to be terribly correct, so you can imagine dressing a Sauropod, classification Diplodocus. Since it's much more costly and time-consuming than the usual museum curator James Davis, the dino will still be lying about in her bones at the time of the social event, but we can give you a preview of her attire.

From the proceeds of the show, Miss Diplodocus will be outfitted in a reptile jumpsuit following trends from the Jurassic period, a blend of subtle clay tones with forest greens and deep beige in the

wet-look finish. Matching reptile boots, of course.

Since Miss Diplodocus is 65 feet long and weighed in at 15 tons, she may require a portly extra long, but in Texas we do things in a big way. Even for a visitor (Miss Tri comes from a prominent old family, about 150 million years old that is, near the foothills of the Rocky Mountains of east central Wyoming.)

But, back to the girls. Our NM models arrayed themselves in a variety of glamorous ensembles, some long, some short, all appropriate for the formal event which will feature couture designer Pauline Trigere commencing her own fall style show. The runway will be built around the dinosaur in the Alfred G. Glasell Jr. Hall in the Museum, the evening beginning with cocktail and hors d'oeuvres at 7:30.

Gowns chosen by several of the women principals of the fund-raising show give another good indicator of fashion trends.

Mrs. Alfred Glasell's new Geoffrey Beene is black satin hemmed at the knee, a silk rose blowing at the waist.

Mrs. George Alcorn has chosen a long-sleeved gray wool, adorned in silver square motifs over the ankle-length gown.

Curator's wife, Mrs. Davis, will wear a white crepe pantsuit, gold beading at the neck and sleeve borders. A red silk floor-length coat, long-sleeved, tops it. Mrs. James J. Johnston's pantsuit is similar.

Mrs. Jack Blanton's pantsuit is royal blue silk with an overcoat panel suit to show silver bead embroidery on the

pantlegs, a Richard Tam design.

Chairman Mrs. Lewis E. Ball brought back a dress and coat of hand-loomed white wool from Greece for the event. Hemmed above the knee, the ensemble is embroidered in gold threads, created by designers Nike & Takis for her.

Mrs. A. J. Knapp's long orange chiffon dress is belted at the natural waistline, as is the matching brocade coat.

Mrs. Marvin H. MacMurphy's long gray flannel skirt is topped by a white sleeveless blouse, beaded gray jacket, a Malcolm Starr.

Mrs. Charles Fleetwood has chosen Jerry Silverman's black crepe cocktail dress. Mrs. W. C. Guerrero also prefers a short gown, here being mocha colored silk with brown collar and cuffs.



Gold sheers will steal the evening spotlight from an Ankylosaurus any day, when done by Bill Blass, left in handkerchief neckline, and Donald Brooks, right. A coin-bordered skirt goes over the harem pants in the Brooks design.

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